

Interview Request Letter & Email Generator

Simple default workflow, paragraph-level editorial control, optional personalization after approval.

Turns a small set of project inputs into an approved one-page Interview Request Letter, then a reusable general email for 50–60 contacts, with optional recipient-specific personalization once the general version is locked in.

STORIES
13 • US-049-061

ROLES TOUCHED
user, admin

EST. EFFORT
33 hours

1. ROLES

ROLE	ACCESS
user	BDR / editorial user. Sets up a project, reviews AI research, approves the letter paragraph by paragraph, generates and approves the reusable general email, and optionally personalizes for one recipient at a time.
admin	Existing admin role, reused as-is (no new permission tier). Manages and versions the universal TRC and GFDI letter templates.

2. USER STORIES

ID	AREA	STORY
US-049	● ACCESS	User/admin access to the module is gated by a dedicated permission flag
US-050	● INPUT	User completes the lightweight project setup form before any AI call runs
US-051	● RESEARCH	System runs short, letter-scoped AI research with source links and hook candidates
US-052	● RESEARCH	User reviews the research and settles on the why-now hook before generation starts
US-053	● GENERATION	System generates the letter in the correct company (TRC/GFDI) structure
US-054	● REVIEW	User approves or regenerates the letter one paragraph at a time; locked paragraphs are never rewritten
US-055	● APPROVAL	User gives one final approval that turns the letter into the project's stable master
US-056	● EMAIL	System generates one reusable general email straight from the approved letter
US-057	● APPROVAL	User approves the general email as the reusable master for outreach
US-058	● PERSONALIZATION	User optionally tailors the approved letter/email for one specific recipient
US-059	● OUTPUT	User copies or exports the approved outputs for use outside the tool
US-060	● ADMIN	Admin manages and versions the universal TRC and GFDI letter templates
US-061	● DATA	System records which template and research version produced each approved letter

3. STORY DETAIL & ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

US-049

ACCESS

As a user, I can only reach the Interview Request Letter & Email Generator if it has been enabled for my account

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- New permission flag (`can_access_interview_letter_generator`) on profiles and invitations, following the exact pattern already used for the other gated modules (Business Cases, Editorial Briefs, Meeting Preparation, Sales Negotiation Coach)
- Admin grants/revokes access through the existing invite and edit-user flows — no new admin surface needed for this alone
- A user without the flag cannot reach the module via direct URL — same enforcement point as the other gated modules
- Every project is automatically associated with the logged-in user — no user-selectable “create as” field

US-050

INPUT

As a user, I complete a lightweight project setup before any AI call runs

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Screen 1 captures: Company (TRC or GFDI, required), Project country (required), Media partner (required), Media partner country / target market (auto-detected from the media partner, editable), Why-now / Event Hook & Important Context (optional, recommended)
- Company selection determines which universal template loads in US-053 — this is a hard branch, not a cosmetic label change
- No recipient-level fields appear at this stage; personalization inputs (US-058) stay deferred until after the general letter and email are approved, keeping the fast path uncluttered

“This is important because AI may not know the exact planned publication window. The user should be encouraged to provide the hook when it is already known. The field can also be left blank so AI can improvise and propose a hook.” — shown beside the Why-now field

US-051

RESEARCH

As the system, I research only what the letter needs, with sources attached

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Research is scoped to letter-relevant facts only, not a general company/country dossier — output as short bullets, each with a direct source link, reusing the app's existing web-search-backed research pattern from the document modules rather than new search infrastructure
- Research actively checks for a why-now / event hook (a live publication window, an announcement, a regional milestone) even when the user already supplied one, so the reviewer in US-052 has something to compare against
- Research runs automatically once Screen 1 is submitted, before the user sees anything else — there is no separate “start research” action

US-052

RESEARCH

As a user, I review the research and settle on the hook before generation starts

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Screen 2 shows the short research and the AI's proposed why-now hook
- A hook supplied by the user in US-050 always takes priority over an AI-proposed one; the user can still overwrite it here
- If the user left the hook blank, the AI proposes the strongest option found during research; the user can accept, edit or replace it
- The confirmed hook and accepted research are stored as part of project state (US-061) and passed into every subsequent generation call — the letter generator in US-053 does not re-run research

As the system, I generate the Interview Request Letter in the correct company structure

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- The system loads the universal letter structure for the selected company (TRC or GFDI) and adapts the country, media partner and hook into it — the two structures are not hard-coded to any one publication or country
- Fixed template wording (the parts of the structure that never vary) is treated as immutable and is never sent back through generation; only the variable paragraphs are model output
- Each variable paragraph carries a strict word budget as part of the structure; a paragraph is generated within that budget, not trimmed after the fact
- The letter is generated paragraph-by-paragraph from the start, feeding directly into the review step (US-054) — not as one long completion split up afterward

US-054

REVIEW

As a user, I approve the letter one paragraph at a time, and nothing I've already approved gets rewritten

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Each variable paragraph is shown with three controls: Approve/Lock, Regenerate, Feedback
- Regenerating a paragraph sends only that paragraph back to the model, together with every already-approved paragraph as immutable context — it must not rewrite paragraphs that are already locked
- Fixed template paragraphs are visually distinguished and are not offered Regenerate/Feedback controls, since they were never model output
- Feedback given on a paragraph is used for that paragraph's regeneration only; it does not retroactively affect already-locked paragraphs
- User can continue approving paragraphs in any order until every required paragraph is locked, then proceed to Final Approve (US-055)

This is new plumbing, not a reuse of the app's existing “regenerate the whole document” pattern (business cases, editorial briefs) — those treat regeneration as discard-and-restream one blob, which would silently rewrite earlier locked paragraphs here. The closest existing precedent is the meeting-prep module's per-section regeneration (targeted slice of context, other accepted pieces shown as “do not contradict”), adapted to a paragraph-sequential template instead of four independent sections.

US-055

APPROVAL

As a user, I give one final approval that turns the letter into the project's stable master

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Final Approve is only offered once every variable paragraph is locked
- Before allowing Final Approve, the system validates: total word count, the one-page constraint, and that all required project fields (company, country, media partner) are present
- Once approved, the letter becomes the project's master version — the primary input for email generation (US-056) and personalization (US-058)
- The master letter is stored as its own immutable snapshot at approval time (see US-061); it is not a live pointer to whatever the paragraphs currently say

US-056

EMAIL

As the system, I generate one reusable general email straight from the approved letter

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- The approved letter is the only required input — the user does not re-enter country, media partner or company
- Output is a single, standard, concise email: keeps the letter's core narrative, reduces background detail, states why the opportunity matters, and includes the confirmed why-now hook
- This general email is the default, fast-path output — designed to be sent as-is to 50–60 contacts without further editing
- Email generation only becomes available once the letter has reached Final Approve (US-055) — there is no draft-email-from-unapproved-letter path

US-057

APPROVAL

As a user, I approve the general email as the reusable master for outreach

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Review-and-approve step mirrors the letter's Final Approve, scoped to one email rather than per-paragraph review
- Once approved, the general email becomes the project's reusable master email, available for copy/export (US-059) and as the base for personalization (US-058)
- Regenerating the general email before approval does not touch the already-approved letter master

US-058

PERSONALIZATION

As a user, I can optionally tailor the approved letter or email for one specific recipient

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Personalization is offered only after the general letter and general email are both approved — the fast path never requires it
- Entry point is a single explicit action (“Personalize for a recipient”) rather than a mode the user has to opt into up front
- Fields, all optional: recipient name, title/position (CEO, Minister, President, etc.), organisation, sector/portfolio, additional recipient context for senior or unusual cases
- Senior-official recipients (PM, President, Minister) get the correct second-person / address conventions applied automatically; the user is not expected to manually rewrite salutation or tone
- Generating a personalized letter/email never overwrites the approved general master — personalization always produces a separate, additional output tied to that recipient
- A project can hold more than one personalized output, one per recipient, without limit

US-059

OUTPUT

As a user, I copy or export the approved outputs for use outside the tool

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Copy action available for the general email and any personalized email, for pasting directly into the sending tool
- Export available for the approved one-page letter, matching the existing document-export pattern already used for business cases, editorial briefs and meeting-prep
- Exporting or copying does not change approval state or trigger any further AI call

US-060

ADMIN

As an admin, I manage and version the universal TRC and GFDI letter templates

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Each company's universal template (fixed wording, variable-paragraph structure, per-paragraph word budgets) is independently admin-editable with full version history and rollback, using the app's existing shared version-history component that already serves the other prompt/template types
- Changing a template does not retroactively alter a letter that was already generated or approved under an earlier version (see US-061)
- Admin can see which template version is currently live for each company
- Templates can be built and tested with placeholder wording now; real TRC/GFDI copy can be dropped in later without a schema change

US-061

DATA

As the system, I record which template and research version produced each approved letter

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

- Every approved letter and every generated email records the exact template version, the accepted why-now hook, and the research snapshot used to produce it
- Editing a company's template after a letter has been approved never rewrites or reinterprets that letter
- Project state — inputs, research, hook, per-paragraph approvals/locks, master letter, master email, personalized outputs — is stored as structured, independently queryable records rather than one merged blob

4. EFFORT ESTIMATE

STORY	SCOPE	HOURS
US-049	Module gating: permission flag, migration, sidebar/middleware wiring	1
US-050	Project setup form incl. target-market auto-detect	2
US-051	Letter-scoped AI research with source links and hook detection	3
US-052	Research + hook review screen, hook priority logic	1
US-053	TRC/GFDI template engine: fixed vs. variable content, per-paragraph word budgets	4
US-054	Paragraph-level approve/lock/regenerate/feedback engine with immutable carried-forward context	7
US-055	Final Approve validation (word count, one-page, required fields) + master snapshot	2
US-056	General email generation from approved letter	2
US-057	General email review + approval as reusable master	1
US-058	Personalization flow incl. senior-official address conventions	4
US-059	Copy / export for letter and email(s)	2
US-060	Admin CRUD + versioning for both company templates (schema + shared UI component reuse)	3
US-061	Template/research/hook version snapshotting per approved letter	1
Total		33